

The flip side

To counter file-sharing pirates, record labels have been bundling bonus DVDs with audio



CDs. The bundled DVDs come with documentary footage and concert videos, and are sold as a package at the price of the regular CD.

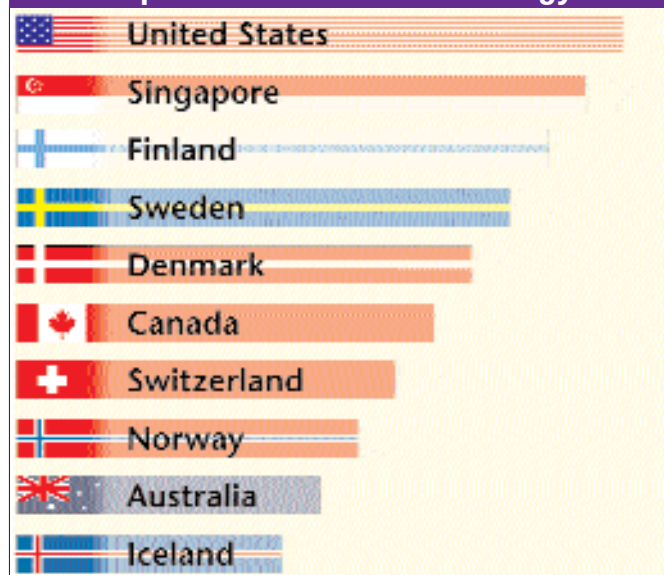
All that might soon change if OneDisc Technologies from Dallas convinces the big names in the music industry about

their new combination disk. This disk plays a DVD video on one side, and a CD audio on the other. It's been designed to play on all existing players. The first such disk, *Kathleen Edwards' 'Live From the Bowery Ballroom'* is already out in the US.

The disc is 0.28mm thicker than a normal DVD disc. Using such a disc will result in reduction of production cost. The patent for this technology currently belongs to a German company named DVD Plus International. Based on this technology, more than 70 titles have been released outside the US.

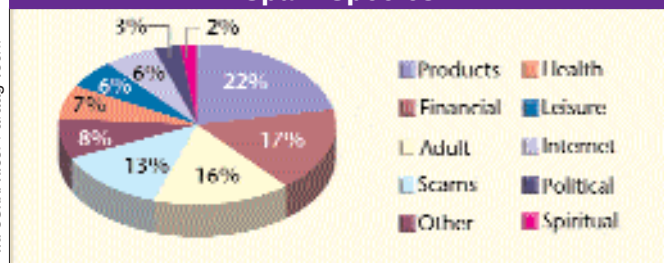
statattack

Top 10 countries in Technology



Source: World Economic Forum

Spam Species



Source: Brightmail Inc

DDR's second take

US memory firm Micron began production of DDR2 memory modules from December 2003. The memory chips on the modules are being manufactured in densities of 256 Mbit, 512 Mbit and 1 Gbit, and should come with capacities of 128 MB to 4 GB. Micron will be shipping this in volume later this year.

Intel's upcoming 'Grantsdale' chipset will use the new DDR2 memory—this means DDR2 memory availability will be crucial for its new microprocessor and chipsets range.

Incidentally, to shore up its bets on the availability of memory, Intel has made investments in Micron, as well as Japanese memory company Elpida.

Equal outgoing rates

The Telephone Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) plans to pass an order that forces mobile operators to provide equal rates for outgoing calls to any network. Most operators provide a lower outgoing call rate for the local network. This will soon be passé. Under the unified license regime, all telephone operators can choose between three licenses: fixed, limited and full mobility. Once a mobility operator fixes the rate for outgoing calls, the same would be maintained for all full mobility networks. The rule will be applicable to fixed and limited mobility operators also. This allows you to choose any network, irrespective of your existing service provider. Such a rule is bound to increase competition between service providers.

redalert

IE address spoof

A vulnerability in Internet Explorer can be exploited to display fake URLs in the address and status bars. This can be used by others to fool a user into disclosing confidential information such as credit card numbers. Secunia discovered this vulnerability, and you can see a demonstration of it at http://www.secunia.com/internet_explorer_address_bar_spoofing_test/. Even though there are about 20 known vulnerabilities in its products, Microsoft did not release any patches in December—it will stick by its decision to only release monthly patches and updates.

Unsafe Yahoo! Messenger

A vulnerability in Yahoo! Messenger allows a hacker to launch XSS (Cross-Site Scripting) attacks. XSS occurs when a Web application gathers malicious data from users when they click on a link in a browser or chat window. This link contains the malicious content, usually encoded in hexadecimal code. The hacker executes malicious code through a Web page that is loaded through a 'ymsgr:' Web address. This vulnerability has been corrected in the latest version of Yahoo! Messenger—5.6 build 1356.

snapshot

World-wide sales of **mobile** phones touched **132.8 million**, in the third quarter of **2003**

Source: Gartner

■ Windows XP improved—Bluetooth and WiFi support, pop-up blocker, better firewall ■ Worms target Windows-based ATM machines